

DECISIONS_LOG - matts-timer-app

Fable's record: Matt's decisions in his words, and Fable's review and sign-off of each Opus build. Newest at the bottom.

2026-09-20 - Repo flipped to Fable-main

Matt's words, in this repo's chat: "Flip it and I will tell you what I want added. It is all local, no internet, no syncing with other apps, etc... still a simple timer but I need it to work correctly on my phone and that is where you come in Fable. Build the subagents and workflow rules. Let me know when you're done and I'll start a new session for the feature adds"

Done by Fable the same day, at commit 4cbb214 as the starting tree:

- `CLAUDE.md` written (Sections 1-4), modelled on `matts-doc-reader` and `matts-calendar-app`, both flipped 2026-09-18.
- `.claude/agents/opus.md` written (model opus, effort high). No `opus-xhigh`: no global rule 3 `xhigh` class exists in this repo. No `fable-*` files: Fable does not spawn Fable in a flipped repo.
- `docs/handoff/FOR_FABLE.md`, `FOR_FABLE_LOG.md`, `NEXT_CHAT_2026-09-20.md` and this log created.
- `tools/md2pdf.py` copied in from `matts-doc-reader` (read there, written here) so every `.md` has its PDF.

Open from this entry: the Fable-owned list in `CLAUDE.md` Section 1 is Fable's proposal and is NOT accepted by Matt yet (`FOR_FABLE.md` item 1).

Walls recorded from his words: no INTERNET, no syncing with other apps, "still a simple timer". Measured the same day: the manifest's only permission is VIBRATE; `dependencies { }` is empty; release is signed with the debug key; no tests exist; `adb devices` listed no device (n=1).

2026-09-20 - v2 build: Fable review of f0071a1 - SIGNED for phone check

Job: Matt's four adds (his words and answers in `docs/handoff/FOR_FABLE.md` item 1). Spec by Fable, built by Opus at f0071a1 on base 32f83ed.

Reviewed line by line against the spec [measured, n=1 read]: `TimerEngine.kt` (492 lines) and `TimerService.kt` (212 lines), the manifest diff, and the Activity's wiring by grep.

- Clock math moved unchanged: `endsAt = now + remainMs`, `pause remainMs = (endsAt - now) >= 0`, `swBase = now - swElapsed`, all `elapsedRealtime`.
- The finish is decided only in `finishCue()` (guarded on running, cue generation counter, re-posts if the clock still shows time). The Activity never calls `timerFinish`.
- Audio focus: `GAIN_TRANSIENT_MAY_DUCK`, requested before the 3 s tick (or at start inside the last 3 s), only when sound is on; abandoned in `RESTART`, `RESET`, `PAUSE`, preset select; held through `TIME`. No stream volume write anywhere (grep: no matches, also none for `AlarmManager` or `INTERNET`).
- Service: not exported, not bound, `specialUse`, `startForeground` first in `onStartCommand`, `onTaskRemoved` does nothing, `START_STICKY` restore through prefs. Partial wake lock only while the countdown runs (remaining + 10 s timeout) and 6 s past the finish.

- Manifest: only the <service> element added by Opus; the five permission lines are Fable's from 32f83ed. dependencies { } empty.
- Opus's ten stated deviations read and accepted (tap target is the digits block; SET & START dimmed-not-disabled at 0:00 so a typed value can commit; restore gated on the boot offset for all state; stopwatch START also triggers the one-time notification ask).
- Build: assembleRelease passes on the committed tree, APK 674,357 bytes [measured, n=1]. dist/MattsTimer.apk NOT replaced yet.

Follow-ups seen, not fixed: (a) a process restored with under 3 s left does not re-request the duck; (b) pause at the last instant can leave "paused 0:00" where START refuses (in v1 too); (c) a process killed and reopened hours later in the same boot shows TIME for the old set.

Everything on-phone is [verify, n=0]: lock-screen display, finish with the screen off, swipe from recents, Spotify ducking. Not DONE until the phone check passes. Matt, 2026-09-20: "I have another session working on my phone so don't interrupt it. Trust the serial is correct. Once that session is done you can ask me for permission to build and test on my phone." No adb from this session until he says that session is done.

2026-09-20 - Rising repeat chime: Fable review of f3d3ed5 - SIGNED for phone check

Matt's words: "one more feature while you are waiting. Can you gradually increase the timer volume once it has expired". Fable asked three questions with recommendations (repeat until he taps; 30 percent to full by the 5th chime, auto-stop at 2 minutes; ramp the app's own sound only, never a volume slider). His answer: "thats fine build it in". Spec by Fable, built by Opus at f3d3ed5 on base 570fa71.

Code diff read line by line [measured, n=1 read] (TimerEngine.kt, TimerService.kt, Tones.kt):

- Tones.play(pcm, gain = 1f) sets the AudioTrack's own volume; synthesis untouched; no stream volume write (grep: no matches, none for AlarmManager or INTERNET either).
- Gains 0.30, 0.475, 0.65, 0.825, 1.0 then 1.0; period = chime length + 1000 ms; buzz with every chime; sound, voice and vibe read at each fire.
- One cue at a time through postCue; alarming cleared only in clearCues(), which RESTART, RESET, preset select and SET & START all reach. timerFinish clears first, then sets alarming.
- No chime starts later than 120 s after the finish, measured on elapsedTime. Accepted deviation: alarming is held until the last chime has rung out (about 124 s worst case) so the wake lock is not dropped mid-tone; the lock's own timeout is 130 s.
- A restored finished state does not ring.
- Build: assembleRelease passes on the committed tree [measured, n=1].

Seen, not fixed: starting the stopwatch or switching tabs does not stop the ring-out; the red flash outlives the 2-minute audio stop; the screen may sleep during the ring-out (the chimes do not depend on it).

On-phone behavior [verify, n=0]. Joins the v2 phone check, still waiting on Matt's word that the other phone session is done.

2026-09-20 - Fix pass before the phone: Fable review of 422e227 - SIGNED for phone check

Matt's words: "change them all nothing broke should touch my phone." Fable's reading, said to him in chat: the three ring-out items plus the two plain v2 defects. Spec by Fable, built by Opus at 422e227 on base 92aa947.

Code diff read line by line [measured, n=1 read]:

- `alarmStop()`: only acts while alarming; clears cues, state stays finished, focus stays held. Called first in `swStart()` and from the new `onTab()` (user tab taps only); rotation and `onCreate` call `setMode()` directly and do not silence the ring.
- Flash follows alarming, not finished (`syncFlash`, one decision point).
- `keepAwake` = running or `swRunning` or alarming, at `onStart`, listener and rotation.
- `timerPause()` with nothing left routes to `timerFinish()`; "paused 0:00" cannot occur.
- `restore()` inside the last 3 s requests the duck; `loadSettings()` runs before it.
- Accepted deviation: a tap on the tab already showing also silences the ring.
- No stream volume, `AlarmManager` or `INTERNET` (grep: no matches). Build passes on the committed tree [measured, n=1].

Still open by Matt's choice: a process killed and reopened hours later in the same boot shows TIME for the old set.

Phone: the calendar session reported at 10:36 it is done with RFGL4275NVH. That is a status notice; the install waits on Matt's permission in this chat.

2026-09-20 - Ten-minute stale rule: Fable review of e5226d2 - SIGNED for phone check

Matt's words: "if the app is "killed with a timer running for more than ten minutes kill it and shut down the timer app. Yes you can install what is needed on my PC and Phone". Fable's reading, told to him in chat before the build: after the process was killed, a set that ended more than ten minutes ago is dropped (no TIME, no notification, no service, app fresh at 35 s); ended ten minutes ago or less restores to silent TIME; still counting keeps running; a never-killed process is unchanged. Built by Opus at e5226d2 on base 0d5a8b2, no deviations.

Code diff read line by line [measured, n=1 read]: `STALE_MS = 600_000`; `finishedAt` set at the finish instant and persisted (0 when not finished); `restore()` drops through `dropSet()` when the end is over ten minutes past, or `finishedAt` is missing, zero or in the future; the ran-out-while-dead branch keeps `finishedAt = savedEnds`. Service shutdown after a drop rides the existing `serviceWanted` paths (`syncService`, `TimerService.onStartCommand`). No stream volume, `AlarmManager` or `INTERNET`. Build passes on the committed tree [measured, n=1].

Known and accepted: a paused set restores after any gap in the same boot (his words name a running timer). First open after upgrading from a persisted finished state without `finishedAt` opens fresh.

Phone order, Matt's words: "hold on my phone that session is ready so it is going to build first" - the Nudge session (Calendar app revision spec [3294e9], reminder-app repo) has the phone first; this session sends no add command until it reports done. Install permission from Matt stands ("Yes you can install what is needed on my PC and Phone"); confirm with him when the phone comes back before running it.

2026-09-20 - Phone check 1 of the e5226d2 build (Fable, adb-driven) - NOT DONE, 2 findings

Matt's words: "yes go ahead and install" and "make sure you test it". Installed with `adb -s RFGL4275NVH install -r` (Success; settings kept: voice PULSE, VIB on). Driven by adb taps; state read from `dumpsys` (activity services, power, audio, notification) and screenshots. Every line below is [measured, n=1] on his phone unless it says otherwise.

PASS

- Nine presets with 15m sixth; no CUSTOM tile. Tap clock opens the wheels at the current preset; flick moves a wheel (35 to 34); typing 12 works.
- First start raised "Allow Timer to send you notifications?"; the set ran behind the prompt; Allowed (POST_NOTIFICATIONS granted, USER_SET).
- Running: foreground service (specialUse), wake lock `matttimer:run` held, notification RUNNING with PAUSE + RESTART, vis PUBLIC. Paused: "PAUSED 0:43", RESUME + RESTART, wake lock released. Finished: TIME, RESTART. RESET: focus 0, service 0, notification 0.
- Duck: focus entry GAIN_TRANSIENT_MAY_DUCK / USAGE_ALARM present at 3 s left, held through TIME, held after the ring ended and after a tab tap, gone after RESET/RESTART.
- Ring-out: chime every 5.0 s on PULSE (predicted 4.989 s); last chime 120 s after the finish; then wake lock released, flash stopped, static red TIME.
- STOPWATCH tab tap at TIME: no chime after the tap (12 s watched).
- Left the app (HOME) and swiped the card out of recents while ringing: same pid, service foreground, chimes kept coming.
- Stopwatch with the app left: notification STOPWATCH with STOP, no wake lock; elapsed right on return; service gone once stopped.
- Screen off (35 s set, phone Dozing): go 11:02:36.592, ticks +32.02, +33.00, +34.00 s, chime +35.00 s, repeats every 5 s.
- No crash in logcat.

FINDINGS (not fixed) 1. Typing in a wheel opens the full QWERTY keyboard, which covers CANCEL and SET & START until the keyboard's check key is pressed. Not "quick, simple and easy". Flicking is unaffected. 2. On his lock screen the timer shows only as a small icon in the top row, not as a card with the countdown and PAUSE / RESTART. Cause not yet separated [verify]: the channel is IMPORTANCE_LOW (silent), and Samsung's lock-screen notification style may be set to icons - a phone setting, his call (global Section 12 item 17).

NOT TESTED by adb: how deep Spotify ducks and whether the chime climb is audible (his ears, headphones, Spotify playing); rotation with the picker open (would need a rotation setting change); lock-screen buttons (phone locked, PIN is his); process-kill restore and the ten-minute rule; pause at 0:00.

State left: phone locked, screen on lock screen, timer at TIME for a 35 s set (ring ends by itself at 2 min; music focus held until RESET/RESTART). `dist/MattsTimer.apk` not replaced - the check has not passed.